



# THE IZAAK WALTON LEAGUE OF AMERICA

## Save Our Streams Stream Quality Survey

Date \_\_\_\_\_

Time \_\_\_\_\_

Name \_\_\_\_\_

Please refer to the Izaak Walton League's volunteer stream monitoring protocol and identification guides to learn how to complete this form. Please use the League's *Field Guide to Aquatic Macroinvertebrates* to complete portions of this stream quality survey form. For assistance, please call (800) BUG-IWLA or send an e-mail to [sos@iwla.org](mailto:sos@iwla.org).

Stream \_\_\_\_\_ Station # \_\_\_\_\_ County/City \_\_\_\_\_

Location \_\_\_\_\_

Weather Conditions (last 72 hours) \_\_\_\_\_

Water temperature \_\_\_\_\_ °F/°C Avg. stream width \_\_\_\_\_ ft. Avg. stream depth \_\_\_\_\_ ft. Flow rate \_\_\_\_\_ (above or below average)

### Rocky Bottom Sampling

Before sampling, record riffle composition on the back of this form. Take 3 samples in the same riffle area, fill out this form, and keep the highest scoring sample for your records. To help track the number of samples you have collected, check one of the boxes below:

- ☐ Sample 1 ☐ Sample 2 ☐ Sample 3 ☐ Is this your highest score sample?

### Muddy Bottom Sampling

Record the total number scoops taken from each habitat type and provide details to best describe the specific habitat on the lines below:

- ☐ Steep bank/vegetated margin \_\_\_\_\_  
☐ Woody debris with organic matter \_\_\_\_\_  
☐ Rock/gravel/sand substrate \_\_\_\_\_  
☐ Silty bottom with organic matter \_\_\_\_\_

### Macroinvertebrate Count

Indicate if the macroinvertebrate species listed was in the video. Total the number of species in each category and multiply according to the correct category. For example, if you identified 3 species in the Less Sensitive category, multiply by 2. Then add together the three totals from each column for your stream's index value. Determine the overall water quality of the stream sample site based on your Total index value. E.g., if your Total index value is 13, the Water Quality Rating is Fair.

| SENSITIVE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | LESS SENSITIVE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | TOLERANT                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Caddisflies (except net spinners)<br><input type="checkbox"/> Mayflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Stoneflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Water snipe flies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Riffle beetles<br><input type="checkbox"/> Water pennies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Gilled snails | <input type="checkbox"/> Dobsonflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Fishflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Common net spinning Caddisflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Crane flies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Damselflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Dragonflies | <input type="checkbox"/> Alderflies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Crayfish<br><input type="checkbox"/> Scuds<br><input type="checkbox"/> Aquatic sowbugs<br><input type="checkbox"/> Clams<br><input type="checkbox"/> Mussels |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Aquatic worms<br><input type="checkbox"/> Black flies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Midge flies<br><input type="checkbox"/> Leeches<br><input type="checkbox"/> Lunged snails                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| # of letters multiplied by 3 = _____                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | # of letters multiplied by 2 = _____                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | # of letters multiplied by 1 = _____                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Now add the three totals from each column for your stream's index value. Total index value = _____                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

Compare the final index value to the following ranges of numbers to determine the water quality of the stream sample site.

### Water Quality Rating

\_\_\_\_\_ Excellent (> 22)      \_\_\_\_\_ Good (17-22)      \_\_\_\_\_ Fair (11-16)      \_\_\_\_\_ Poor (< 11)